

UBI Experiments: Cash Doesn't Make People Lazy

Four programmes, four continents, one consistent result

Alaska

1982–present · 40+ years running

\$1,700

/person/yr (2025)

Oil revenue paid out to all
Every resident, no conditions

Results:

✓ Employment held ✓ Spending up ✓ Poverty down

Health spend: every \$1 paid out saves more than \$1 later

Finland

2017-2018 · Randomised controlled trial

€560

/person/mo

2,000 unemployed people
Monthly, no conditions

Results:

✓ Employment = control group (no laziness)

✓ Wellbeing↑ ✓ Trust↑ ✓ Health↑ ✓ Depression↓

Stockton SEED

2019-2021 · California, USA

\$500

/person/mo

125 residents
Two years, no conditions

Results:

Full-time employment: 28% → 40% (+12 pts)

✓ Cash made them job-hunt harder ✓ Income volatility↓

Kenya · GiveDirectly

2018–present · Largest UBI trial worldwide

\$22.50

/person/mo (12 yrs)

Thousands of villages
Long-run cash transfers

Results:

✓ New businesses↑ ✓ Nutrition up ✓ Violence↓

✓ Lump-sum recipients built better businesses

Cross-Study Conclusion

Across trials in Finland, Alaska, Germany, Africa and US cities:

Almost nobody quits. Some cut hours to care for family or study; others use the net to find better work.

Funding path: payroll tax → capital / compute / carbon mix · a small slice of AI's extra GDP growth suffices